

A REALLY GREAT WARMUP

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #116

Think about it . . . what is a Warmup Routine for? There might be concerns like “getting our muscles warmed up so we don’t hurt ourselves.” Good one! Or “getting my sound, my tone together for the day,” or “getting the fluidity of my fingers rolling.” All good stuff. Maybe we could say that we warm up to “get comfortable in our own skin.”

There are definitely times in our study when a particular warmup or a particular focus is developmentally important. For this, you should listen to your coach/mentor, or the advice I give you personally at www.JazzWire.net. But even taking that into account, having your warmup reflect the real world is always a great way to go. Why spend 20% of your musical life playing something you will NEVER play in front of other people?

Your New Warmup = playing challenging jazz songs that you know

Play just the melodies, no soloing. Play JAZZ songs (ie. typically bebop era songs) that challenge you. Playing one song (one time through) will take you less than a minute. If you play 20 songs, your warmup is about 15 minutes long. We are playing the greatest Jazz Etudes ever written. The good news - no need to buy a new book for this warmup!

WHAT TO DO AS YOU ARE WARMING UP

- Do this unaccompanied. Just you and the melody. Occasionally a metronome.
- Think about the Notes and Rhythms. Are you playing the song correctly?
- Think about the Rests. Rests are part of the music. **PLAY THE RESTS.**
- Think about your Tone (even, full, beautiful, personal).
- Think about your Time (accurate, even, relaxed).
- Think about your Feel (can I hear and *feel* the Feel you are playing?).
- Think about your Articulation (this is what makes you swing and/or groove).

THE BAD NEWS

There are 4,342, 675 ways to get this stuff wrong, backwards, or inaccurate. Drilling in wrong stuff is bad for you! Get PERSONAL input from a mentor, a coach, a teacher.

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